

BUS 123 — Solving Business Problems with Technology · Fall 2026

INTRO-M01-L01

Essentials of Software Applications — OneDrive

PRE-READING · Reading
Material Only

Pre-Reading

Essentials of Software Applications — OneDrive

Gerrish School of Business · BUS123

CONNECT TO PRIOR KNOWLEDGE

This is the first lesson of BUS123 — Solving Business Problems with Technology. You are beginning with a clean slate, which means the prior knowledge here is the everyday digital experience you already bring to the room: using a smartphone, saving files to a computer, logging into a school portal. This lesson builds directly on that familiarity and asks a sharper question: are you using these tools casually, or professionally? By the end of this module, you will have the foundation to answer confidently.

WHAT IS MICROSOFT 365?

Microsoft 365 is a subscription-based suite of productivity software that includes Excel, Word, PowerPoint, OneDrive, Outlook, and Teams. As an Endicott student, you have full access at no cost through your college account — which includes installing the desktop applications on up to five personal devices.

Application	Primary Purpose	Used In BUS123
Excel	Numerical data, calculations, financial analysis	Primary tool — every module
Word	Professional documents, reports, memos	Selected written deliverables
PowerPoint	Presentations, pitch decks, visual communication	Final project and selected activities
OneDrive	Cloud storage and file sync across all devices	Required for all file storage and submission

WHAT IS ONEDRIVE?

OneDrive is Microsoft's cloud storage and synchronization service. When you save a file to your OneDrive folder on your laptop, it is automatically copied to Microsoft's servers and made available on every other device connected to the same account. This means:

- You can never truly "lose" the file to a dead laptop — it lives in the cloud.
- Every device stays current — edit on your phone and the changes appear on your laptop.
- Sharing is a link, not an attachment — colleagues see the live version, not a stale copy.
- Version history is automatic — OneDrive saves prior versions so you can roll back mistakes.

✓ Endicott-Specific Detail

Your Endicott College Microsoft account includes 1 TB of OneDrive storage. This is separate from any personal Microsoft account you may already have. Always confirm you are signed in to your @endicott.edu account — not a personal Hotmail or Outlook.com account — before saving course files.

INSTALLING AND ACTIVATING MICROSOFT 365

If you have not already installed the desktop applications, follow these steps using your Endicott student credentials:

- 1 Go to portal.office.com and sign in with your @endicott.edu email address.
- 2 Click Install apps in the top right corner and select Microsoft 365 apps.
- 3 Run the downloaded installer and follow the on-screen prompts.
- 4 Open any Office app (Excel, Word, or PowerPoint), go to File → Account, and confirm your Endicott email appears under User Information.
- 5 If you see a different account, click Sign Out, then Sign In with your @endicott.edu address.

■ Common Mistake

Students who already have a personal Microsoft account often find that OneDrive syncs to the wrong account. Before saving any BUS123 files, open OneDrive, click your profile icon, and verify the account shown ends in @endicott.edu.

SETTING UP YOUR BUS123 FOLDER STRUCTURE IN ONEDRIVE

Consistent folder organization is a professional habit, not a preference. In BUS123, all files must be saved inside a specific folder structure in your Endicott OneDrive so that instructors can access and verify your work.

Folder Level	Name	What Goes Here
1 — Top level	BUS123	Everything for this course
2 — Subfolders	INTRO / EXCEL / MATH	One folder per track
3 — Module folders	M01, M02, M03 . . .	One folder per module within each track

FILE NAMING CONVENTION

Every file you save in BUS123 must follow the course naming convention. This makes it easy to identify, sort, and share your work without confusion.

Format:

`LastName_FirstName_BUS123_ModuleN.xlsx`

Example:

`Reyes_Taylor_BUS123_Module01.xlsx`

✓ Why This Matters

Instructors receive dozens of files with names like 'homework.xlsx' or 'final_FINAL_v3.xlsx.' A properly named file tells your instructor exactly who submitted it and what it contains — before it is even opened. This is a professional habit that carries into every workplace.

SAVING, SYNCING, AND VERIFYING A FILE

Saving a file to your OneDrive folder is not the same as the file being available in the cloud. There is a brief delay between saving locally and the file completing its upload to Microsoft's servers. Always verify sync status before submitting.

Sync Icon	What It Means	What to Do
● Blue circle / arrows	File is currently uploading	Wait — do not submit yet

✓ Green checkmark	File is fully synced to the cloud	Safe to copy share link and submit
✗ Red X	Sync error — file did not upload	Check your internet connection and re-save

KEY VOCABULARY

Microsoft 365

A subscription-based suite of productivity applications including Excel, Word, PowerPoint, OneDrive, Outlook, and Teams. Endicott students have full access at no cost through their college credentials.

OneDrive

Microsoft's cloud storage and file synchronization service. Files saved to OneDrive are automatically backed up to remote servers and accessible across all signed-in devices.

Cloud Storage

Files stored on remote servers accessed over the internet rather than on a physical hard drive. Enables multi-device access and protects against local hardware failure.

Sync

The process of ensuring the local copy of a file and the cloud copy are identical and up to date. Indicated by a green checkmark on the file icon in your OneDrive folder.

Desktop Application

A software program installed and running directly on your computer, as opposed to a browser-based version. Desktop apps have full features and work offline.

File Naming Convention

A standardized format for naming files so they are identifiable, sortable, and consistent. BUS123 format: LastName_FirstName_BUS123_ModuleN.xlsx.

Activation

The process of signing in to Microsoft 365 with your Endicott credentials to unlock full access to the desktop applications. Verified under File → Account in any Office app.

Version History

OneDrive's automatic record of prior saved states of a file. Allows you to restore an earlier version if content is accidentally deleted or overwritten.